

Erdong Xu

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Education

The George Washington University <i>Ph.D. in Economics</i>	2026
Tufts University <i>M.S. in Economics</i>	2020
Xiamen University <i>B.A. in Economics; B.A. in Philosophy</i>	2017

Fields of Interest

Political Economy; Economic History; Development Economics

Job Market Paper

Printing Morality: Uncle Tom's Cabin and the Antebellum Political Realignment

Summary: This paper shows how a widely circulated cultural work, Uncle Tom's Cabin shaped presidential voting patterns and contributed to the political realignment of the 1850s. Using advertisement records extracted from digitized historical newspapers, I construct county-level exposure to the novel based on travel times along the 1850 transportation network. Difference-in-differences estimates show that counties with greater exposure experienced larger declines in Democratic vote shares and stronger movement toward the emerging Republican Party during the 1850s. Evidence from naming patterns, Union Army enlistment, newspaper discourse, and Republican campaign rhetoric suggests that the novel reshaped moral sentiment toward slavery, amplified antislavery discussion, and helped convert cultural response into partisan mobilization.

Presented at: World Economic History Congress, 2025; GW Applied Micro Brownbag, 2023; Warwick SAGE Summer School, 2023; ACES Summer School, 2023; Economic History Association Annual Meeting (Poster), 2023

Research Experience

Research Assistant, The George Washington University <i>Advisor: Prof. Maggie X. Chen</i>	2021–2023
Research Assistant, Xiamen University <i>Advisor: Prof. Cheryl X. Long</i>	2016–2017

Teaching Experience

Instructor, The George Washington University <i>Principles of Mathematics for Economics</i>	Spring 2024
Graduate Teaching Assistant, The George Washington University <i>Principles of Mathematics for Economics, International Trade</i>	2022–2024
Instructor, Osher Lifelong Learning Institute, Tufts University <i>A Brief Introduction to Shenzhen</i>	Fall 2019

Skills

Programming: Python, Stata, QGIS
Languages: English (fluent), Chinese (native)

References

Prof. Maggie X. Chen

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Prof. Alessandra Fenizia

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